

than typing it all out. If it's a multi-GB music directory, you'll end up with aching fingers before you're even halfway through. Thankfully, we've got an easier way. You can create a small batch file, and then add it to the right-click context menu, so that all you will have to do is right-click and select "Print Directory Contents" (or something like that). First, open Notepad, and type in the following:

@echo off

```
dir %1 /o:g > c:\directory.txt
start /w notepad /p c:\directory.txt
del c:\directory.txt
exit
```

Save this in the root of the C drive as "print_directory.bat". Now, in order to add this option to the right-click context menu, you will need to edit the default folder properties. In Windows Explorer, go to **Tools > Folder Options > File Types**. Click on the "File Folder" file type and then click on the **Advanced** button at the bottom right. Now, click on the "New..." button. In the **Action** field, enter the name of the action, such as "Print Directory" or "Print Contents", and in the "Application to be used to perform this action" field, fill in "C:\print_directory.bat". Click OK thrice and then close to exit.

Before you do anything, check to see that if you double-click a folder it actually opens normally, because sometimes the Search function gets set as default. You really don't want to have to right-click every folder and select **Open**. So let's fix this first:

Open the Registry Editor and navigate to **HKEY_CLASSES_ROOT\Directory\shell**. Edit the default value (which might have changed to "Open" or "Find") and change it to "Explorer".

Now make sure you can double-click and open folders again, and then you're

ready to test the **Print Contents / Directory** command you just made.

Right-click on a directory and select "Print Directory" (or whatever you called it). You will get a pop-up that will ask you where to save "directory.mdi". This is the Microsoft Document Imaging format, which makes a nice, neat, and readable file that will list out the contents of the directory. Rename it to the name of the directory, and then save it. It will open with Microsoft Office Document Imaging.



No To All

When you're copying files into a folder that have the same name, you get a dialog box that asks for confirmation about whether you want to overwrite the existing files. The options that you are given are Yes, No, and Yes To All. But what happens when you want to say "No To All"? Well, there's a simple solution actually; just hold down [Shift] and press No. This is as good as saying "No To All".



Speedier Boot

If you feel your computer takes too long to boot, you can use a tool that Microsoft provides to monitor your bootup. The tool is called BootVis, and is available from www.onecomputerguy.com/software/bootvis.exe.

Uncompress the self-extracting archive and run it. Go to **Trace > Next Boot + Driver Delays**. Next, reboot your computer and wait for BootVis to provide you with the results. You will see some graphs of your system startup, and then go to **Trace > Optimize System**. The system will reboot again. Re-run the **Next Boot + Driver Delays** and see how much time has been saved.



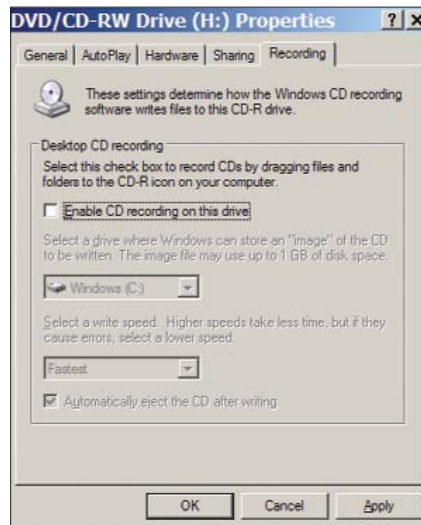
End-Task Automatically

Windows waits too long before killing a non-responsive task. To remedy this, in the Registry Editor, go to **HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Control Panel\Desktop**, change the value of the "AutoEndTasks" key to "1". Here, also change the "WaitToKillApp Timeout" key's value to the number you want. The default is 20000 milliseconds.



Stop Burning

You might certainly want to stop Windows from trying to act as a CD burner, trying to write to CDs and popping up "Write



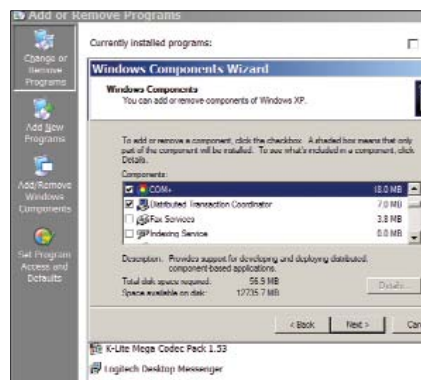
Stop Windows from burning CDs

CD" dialogs every time you insert a blank CD—this is just plain irritating. To disable that functionality, open Windows Explorer, right-click on your CD drive, select **Properties**, click on the **Recording** tab, and uncheck the "Enable CD recording on this drive" box.



Additional Programs?

You don't see all the programs in the **Add/Remove Programs** list because Windows hides a lot of Windows components. If you want to see everything, open the **\Windows\inf\sysoc.inf** file, press [Ctrl] + [H] (find and replace), search for "hide", and leave



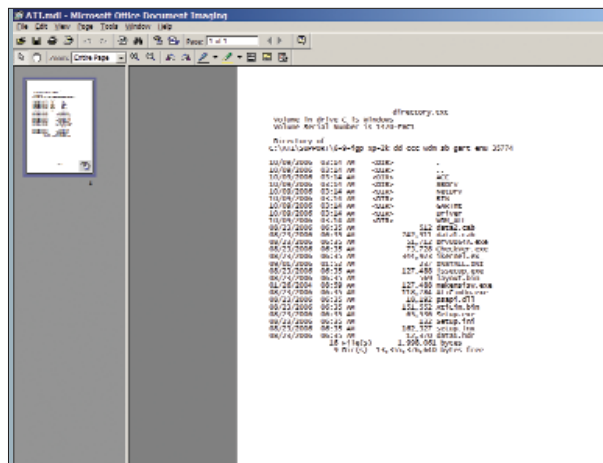
Find hidden Windows components

the "replace" field blank. Choose to replace all, and then save the file.

The file lists Components in the following order:

[Components]
NtComponents=ntoc.dll,NtOscSetupProc,4
WBEM=ocgen.dll,OcEntry,wbemoc.inf,hid
e,7

Whatever was previously hidden in the **Windows Components** section will all now be visible in the same section in the **Add/Remove Programs** list. ■



Printing out a directory's contents